

Megan R. Lancaster

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About Me

PMP®-certified project manager, senior learning experience designer, and STEM educator with more than a decade of experience leading instructional design, educational technology, and faculty-support initiatives in higher education. I love working with experts to turn complex ideas into meaningful experiences that invite curiosity and help learners build confidence. With graduate training in science education and engineering physics, I bring a hands-on approach to curriculum, assessment, and learning technology, grounded in a commitment to expanding access to education.

Education and Certifications

- **Project Management Professional (PMP) Certification**, Project Management Institute
- **M.S. Science Education**, North Carolina State University
- **M.S. Engineering Physics**, Appalachian State University
- **B.S. Physics**, University of North Carolina at Greensboro

Learning Design Experience

Senior Learning Experience Designer and Project Manager

Duke University | Durham, NC (Remote)

April 2021 - Present

- Partnered with experts across engineering, nursing, data science, and corporate education to design and launch 50+ online courses and specializations, translating complex subject matter into relevant learning experiences for students and professionals.
- Designed interactive activities, cases, and assessments that connect concepts to real-world decisions and hands-on tasks across science, technology, business, and the social sciences. Supported courses and specializations spanning Space Medicine, cloud computing, MLOps, data engineering, Explainable AI, Data Science with R, ESG, and leadership; Medical Sociology through a National Equity Opportunity Network partnership; and Digital You, a for-credit undergraduate course exploring AI's technical and ethical dimensions across disciplines.
- Developed a [Coursera Design Guide and templates](#) that connect learning goals to course structure, practice, assessment, and learner support.
- Led learning design and project management for AI for Nurses with Duke School of Nursing and Johnson & Johnson. Used survey data and nurse co-design sessions to

build a three-course sequence with interactive explanations, practice, and five guided clinical cases.

- Built a Coursera plugin and Claude-powered Interactivity Generator to help designers turn content and learning goals into hands-on exploration and knowledge checks. Included editable previews, accessible text alternatives, and SME review of content.
- Co-designed Coursera's integrated labs interface, now deployed platform-wide, applying Universal Design for Learning to reduce cognitive load in technical courses.
- Co-developed a course review framework combining Quality Matters, OLC, and Duke standards; created Claude Skills to support team intake, scoping, and course design.

Learning Experience Designer

Duke University | Durham, NC (Remote)

January 2020 - April 2021

- Led design sprints with faculty across Duke University and Duke Health, translating complex subject matter into high-impact online and hybrid learning experiences.
- Developed interactive prototypes and assessments, then iterated using learner analytics and faculty feedback to improve engagement and demonstrate learning outcomes.

Educational Technology Specialist

High Point University | High Point, NC

July 2018 - December 2019

- Supported 100+ faculty in adopting instructional technology and Blackboard; created a Bootcamp program that improved faculty confidence by 32% and reduced support requests by an average of 18%.
- Designed the university's first cross-disciplinary Pathway system using e-portfolios and achievement badges; analyzed adoption and engagement data to guide improvement.

Instructional Designer and Project Manager

UNC Greensboro | Greensboro, NC

September 2013 - July 2015

- Coordinated faculty, multimedia developers, and designers to deliver online courses on Canvas and WordPress, aligning development milestones with accessibility and institutional requirements.
- Designed and launched UNCG's first MOOC, expanding opportunities to learn beyond the university's enrolled student population.

STEM Teaching and Curriculum Experience

Virtual Mission Flight Director, Challenger Learning Center of Maine *(March 2024 – July 2025)*

Led NASA-program virtual missions and supplemental K–12 STEM curriculum for teachers nationwide.

Engineering is Elementary Coordinator, UNC Greensboro *(August 2015 - December 2017)*

Designed STEM professional development for dozens of educators and implemented Engineering is Elementary across schools, led 4-6 week lessons, and coached teachers in adapting hands-on engineering experiences for their students.

Science Teacher, 7th–12th grade, New Garden Friends School *(July 2014 – May 2015)*

Designed and taught the full middle and high school science curriculum using NGSS-aligned inquiry methods.

STEM Instructor and eStudies Academic Consultant, Duke TIP *(June 2011 – April 2015)*

Designed and taught hands-on STEM courses (space exploration, physics, digital circuit design) for gifted learners; reviewed curriculum and trained instructional staff.

Selected Scholarship and Recognition

- Science education publications in Journal of Research in Science Teaching (2024) and Science Scope (2015, 2016).
- Presentations on Coursera Labs (Coursera Conference, 2022) and trauma-informed MOOC design (UPCEA, 2024)
- Coursera Vision & Values Award (2025, team award); Duke Presidential Award (2021, team award)

Methods and Tools

Learning design: Universal Design for Learning (UDL), ADA and WCAG/Section 508 accessibility compliance, learning strategy, adult learning theory, design thinking, evaluation and learner feedback (Qualtrics), quality assurance rubrics (Quality Matters, OLC), content creation and graphic/media design (Camtasia, Adobe Creative Cloud), NGSS

Project and program management: Project and portfolio management (waterfall, hybrid, and Agile), project scoping, stakeholder engagement, cross-functional collaboration, coaching and mentoring, project tracking (Monday.com)

Learning technologies: Canvas, Blackboard, Brightspace, EdStem (for-credit), Coursera (professional, non-credit)

AI and data-informed practice: AI-assisted workflows (including Claude Code, Claude Skills), data-driven decision-making